Effective Date:
10/01/2025

Background:
The COLA updates are effective every year on the **first day of October**. For Semi-Annual Reporting (SAR) households (HHs) where October falls mid-period, the COLA is treated as a county initiated mid period change.

Purpose:
This notice provides staff with an overview of the COLA changes and instructions for implementation.

Policy:
The COLA mass update ran from September 13, 2025, through September 16, 2025. The Scratch Budget has been updated to reflect the new amounts. The following changes are part of the FFY 2026 COLA:

<table>
<tr><th>Item</th><th>Change</th></tr>
<tr><td>Maximum Allotments</td><td>Increased as follows:
<table>
<tr><th>HH Size</th><th>Maximum Allotment</th></tr>
<tr><td>1</td><td>$298</td></tr>
<tr><td>2</td><td>546</td></tr>
<tr><td>3</td><td>785</td></tr>
<tr><td>4</td><td>994</td></tr>
<tr><td>5</td><td>1,183</td></tr>
<tr><td>6</td><td>1,421</td></tr>
<tr><td>7</td><td>1,571</td></tr>
<tr><td>8</td><td>1,789</td></tr>
<tr><td>Each additional member</td><td>Add $218</td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
<tr><td>Minimum Allotment</td><td>Increased from $23 to $24 for a HH of 1 or 2</td></tr>
<tr><td>Income Eligibility Standards</td><td>Increased as follows:
<table>
<tr><th rowspan="2">HH Size</th><th colspan="4">Percentage of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL)</th></tr>
<tr><th>100% Maximum Net</th><th>130% Maximum Gross</th><th>165% Elderly/Disabled (E/D) Separate HH</th><th>200% Modified Categorical Eligibility (MCE) Limit</th></tr>
<tr><td>1</td><td>$1,305</td><td>$1,696</td><td>$2,152</td><td>$2,610</td></tr>
<tr><td>2</td><td>1,763</td><td>2,292</td><td>2,909</td><td>3,526</td></tr>
<tr><td>3</td><td>2,221</td><td>2,888</td><td>3,665</td><td>4,442</td></tr>
<tr><td>4</td><td>2,680</td><td>3,483</td><td>4,421</td><td>5,360</td></tr>
<tr><td>5</td><td>3,138</td><td>4,079</td><td>5,177</td><td>6,276</td></tr>
<tr><td>6</td><td>3,596</td><td>4,675</td><td>5,934</td><td>7,192</td></tr>
<tr><td>7</td><td>4,055</td><td>5,271</td><td>6,690</td><td>8,110</td></tr>
<tr><td>8</td><td>4,513</td><td>5,867</td><td>7,446</td><td>9,026</td></tr>
<tr><td>Each additional member</td><td>Add $459</td><td>Add $596</td><td>Add $757</td><td>Add $918</td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
</table>

<table>
<tr><td>Shelter Deduction</td><td>Increased from $712 to $744</td></tr>
<tr><td>Standard Deduction</td><td>Increased as follows:
<table>
<tr><th>Eligible HH Size</th><th>Standard Deduction</th></tr>
<tr><td>1-3</td><td>$209</td></tr>
<tr><td>4</td><td>$223</td></tr>
<tr><td>5</td><td>$261</td></tr>
<tr><td>6 or more</td><td>$299</td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
<tr><td>Standard Medical Deduction</td><td>Remains at $150</td></tr>
<tr><td>Homeless Shelter Allowance</td><td>Increased from $190.30 to $198.99</td></tr>
<tr><td>Standard Utility Allowance (SUA)</td><td>Increased from $645 to $663</td></tr>
<tr><td>Limited Utility Allowance (LUA)</td><td>Increased from $166 to $170</td></tr>
<tr><td>Telephone Utility Allowance (TUA)</td><td>Increased from $19 to $20</td></tr>
<tr><td>Resource Limit</td><td>Remains the same as follows:
$4,500 for a HH that includes an E/D member
$3,000 for a HH without an E/D HH member

Note: The lottery and gambling winnings reporting threshold is equal to the maximum resource limit for a HH that includes an E/D member.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Sponsored Noncitizen In-Kind Value for Indigent Determinations</td><td>Increased as follows:
<table>
<tr><th>HH Size</th><th>Housing</th><th>Utilities</th><th>Food</th><th>Clothing</th></tr>
<tr><td>1</td><td>$422</td><td>$89</td><td>$231</td><td>$70</td></tr>
<tr><td>2</td><td>560</td><td>102</td><td>493</td><td>137</td></tr>
<tr><td>3</td><td>613</td><td>105</td><td>632</td><td>204</td></tr>
<tr><td>4</td><td>645</td><td>111</td><td>781</td><td>272</td></tr>
<tr><td>5</td><td>645</td><td>111</td><td>947</td><td>346</td></tr>
<tr><td>6</td><td>645</td><td>111</td><td>1,095</td><td>415</td></tr>
<tr><td>7</td><td>645</td><td>111</td><td>1,221</td><td>484</td></tr>
<tr><td>8</td><td>645</td><td>111</td><td>1,332</td><td>538</td></tr>
<tr><td>9</td><td>645</td><td>111</td><td>1,466</td><td>618</td></tr>
<tr><td>10 or more</td><td>645</td><td>111</td><td>1,586</td><td>677</td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
</table>

Notices:
Timely notice is not required when processing a mass change. The Notice to All CalFresh Recipients (CF 11) is available in the Eligibility Forms Library (EFL) for HHs that have questions about the COLA.

COLA informing posters are required to be displayed in areas frequented by HHs at Family Resource Centers (FRCs). Posters must remain on display from October 1, 2025, until November 30, 2025. The COLA informing posters are attached to this letter.

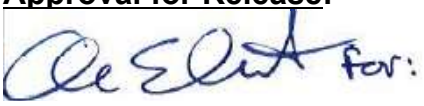
References:

All County Information Notice (ACIN) I-46-25, I-48-25
All County Letter (ACL) 25-36
Scratch Budget – Self-Sufficiency Services Desk Aid
10-2025 CalFresh Assistance Standards Table

Sunset Date:

This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 09/30/2026.

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services